

The Department of Agriculture, Fisheries and Forestry manages 10 tariff rate quotas (TRQs) under the Australia-United Kingdom Free Trade Agreement (A-UK FTA), including sheepmeat.

Australian exporters can export sheepmeat at a 0% tariff rate under the following quota volumes.

	Agreement Year	Quota year	Quantity (MT)
1		2023	14,726
2		2024	30,556
3		2025	36,111
4		2026	41,667
5		2027	47,222
6		2028	52,778
7		2029	58,333
8		2030	63,889
9		2031	69,444
10		2032	75,000

Access to the quotas will be administered via an allocation system until the available quota amount has been exhausted.

Exporters can use the [Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade tariff portal](#) to find the current tariff rate applying to their product and to compare the tariff reduction received under the A-UK FTA.

Key dates to remember

- 1 January - Quota year commences
- 31 October – Last day to return, retain allocation
- 16 November – Applications for annual allocation are due
- 31 December – Quota year finishes

Current Quota usage

The quota usage tables show the total quantity of quota used by Australia for A-UK FTA products. The tables are updated regularly.

Check out the [current quota usage](#) for UK sheepmeat.

Allocation Holders

Allocations of entitlement are available to exporters based on prior shipping history. The department will allocate 100% of the available volume within a quota year unless the previous quota year has

utilised over 95% of the total annual volume. In this event, the department will limit the following quota years allocations to 95% to avoid triggering the safeguard provisions within the A-UK FTA.

The calculations for allocations take into account quantity of sheepmeat shipped using market specific performance and global shipments. Invitations to apply for the quota are sent to eligible exporters prior to the start of the quota year. Applications for allocated quota for the following year close on 16 November each year.

In October of each year the department will run a reallocation process where allocation holders can return quota they don't intend to use, retain quota they will use, or request more allocation for the remainder of the year.

Transfer of allocated quota

If existing allocation holders wish to transfer some or all their quota allocation to other exporters, they can do so by completing the [Notice to transfer annual quota entitlements](#) form.

Exporters cannot transfer quota between other quotas, for example: WTO and A-UK FTA.

Apply for a TRQ certificate for sheepmeat

Exporters will need to apply to export sheepmeat to the UK at the reduced tariff rate.

To apply for a quota, certificate an exporter must:

- lodge a request for permit (RFP) through the department's electronic documentation system, [EXDOC](#)
- tick the Quota indicator box, enter the quota year and write A-UK FTA in quota type.

Issuing a TRQ certificate

Under the A-UK FTA agreement the department is required to provide a paper-based certificate with an original government stamp and signature for all A-UK FTA certificates.

Once an application is approved, an A-UK FTA certificate will be generated and posted to the exporter. The department can send certificates to exporters using Express Post through Australia Post if the exporter provides the department with self-addressed envelopes.

A-UK FTA certificates cannot be amended without the corresponding export documentation being amended so if there is a change to the exporter, importer, product type or quantity of the shipment after the certificate has been issued the existing certificate may need to be cancelled and a replacement certificate issued. Contact [Quota Administration](#) if there is a change to any details on the certificate.

Note: Quota administration is cost recovered on a per certificate basis in accordance with the Export Charges (Imposition-General) Regulation 2021 and the Export Control (Fees and Payments) Rules

2021. Exporters are invoiced monthly for any quota certificates issued. The current cost recovered amount is \$37 per certificate issued.

Airfreighting consignments

Airfreight consignments may require urgent documentation and the Quota Administration team will endeavour to process these manually if requested.

If an airfreight certificate is required urgently, email the Quota Administration team with the RFP number of the consignment that requires a manual certificate. The email must be received by the Quota Administration team no later than 1:00pm (Canberra time) for same-day processing.

Processing of same day certificates cannot be guaranteed as processing and dispatch is dependent on staff availability and couriers.

Legislation

The [Export Control \(Tariff Rate Quotas—Sheepmeat and Goatmeat Export to the European Union and United Kingdom\) Rules 2021](#) governs the rules around TRQs for sheepmeat to the UK.

Data collection

We report on export quotas using data submitted for certificate applications.

Contact us

Phone: 02 6272 4068

Email: quota.admin@aff.gov.au

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/biosecurity-trade/export/from-australia/quota/uk-eu-quotas/uk-sheepmeat-quota>